

SUBTITLES

Pellichupulu — but she doesn't speak the language.

Genre: Romantic Comedy **Format:** Short Series **Duration:** 60 Episodes × 2–2.5 Mins **Cast:** 2 Artists. Nobody else on screen, ever. **Location:** ONE flat. Hall, kitchen, one bedroom door, bathroom door, balcony. **Timeline:** Friday 4:10 PM → Monday 11:00 AM. Three days.

Tagline: *Rendu bhashalu. Okka flat. / Duto bhasha. Ekta flat.*

1. LOGLINE

He flies to Hyderabad to meet the girl his family chose, walks into her flat a day early, and discovers she does not speak a single language he speaks — and then the cyclone grounds every flight out of Kolkata for three days.

2. PITCH

Abhiram Vempati has done his homework. He has read the biodata, memorised the names, ironed a shirt, and arrived at the flat in Gachibowli four hours early because his flight from Vizag landed early and he is that kind of person.

The girl who opens the door says, *"Tumi ke?"*

He doesn't know what that means. He will not know what that means for another eleven minutes.

Titir Bose was born in Kolkata, raised in Kolkata, and has lived in Hyderabad for four months and nine days. Her father is Bengali. Her mother's family is the distant Telugu connection that makes this alliance technically a family matter — a connection so distant that nobody on either side can draw the line accurately, which is going to become a significant problem around episode thirty-two.

She speaks Bengali. She speaks English when she has to and hates how it feels. She speaks roughly forty words of Telugu, nineteen of which are food.

He speaks Telugu, English, and a Hindi so confident and so wrong that it will cause two separate catastrophes.

The families were supposed to land at nine that night. Then the cyclone over the Bay of Bengal closed Kolkata airport, then the hotel released the booking his father had made, and then it started raining in Hyderabad, and now there are two strangers in one flat for three days with no shared language and a phone translation app that is doing its absolute best.

What follows is sixty episodes of two people building a language out of nothing — gestures, food, a notebook, nine games, and one word she teaches him on the first night that he will use, correctly, in the last thirty seconds of the season.

3. THE LANGUAGE SYSTEM

This is the whole show. Get it right and nothing else matters much.

3.1 On screen

- **Bengali** appears with burned-in English subtitles.
- **Telugu** appears with burned-in English subtitles.
- **English** is unsubtitled.
- The subtitles are for the audience. **Neither character can see them.** Never write a beat where a character responds to something they could only have known from a subtitle.

3.2 The four-stage arc

Stage	Eps	How they communicate
1 — Nothing	1–12	Phone translation app, gestures, single English words. Everything is a negotiation. Maximum comedy, maximum friction.
2 — The Pidgin	13–28	They invent a working dialect: her broken Telugu, his broken Hindi, English nouns, and about thirty agreed hand signs. Funnier than stage 1 because now they're <i>fluent in something that doesn't exist</i> .
3 — Through	29–46	They stop translating. They speak their own languages at each other and it works, because by now they know what the other is going to say. The audience, with subtitles, is ahead of neither of them.
4 — Chosen	47–60	Each starts speaking the <i>other's</i> language, badly, deliberately, as an act of affection. This is the romance. There is no scene in which anyone says "I love you."

3.3 The Notebook

Episode 6: he starts writing Bengali words in the back of a diary, phonetically, wrong.

It reappears in Eps 14, 22, 33, 41, 52. By Episode 55 it has ninety-one words in it.

Episode 60 is about that notebook. Do not draw attention to it before then. No inserts. It should just be a thing lying around in shot for fifty-four episodes.

3.4 The Word

Episode 9, late at night, she teaches him one Bengali word. It's a small moment, thrown away, no music.

He uses it once, wrongly, in Episode 27 for comedy.

He uses it correctly in the last line of Episode 60.

The word is "thakbe?" — *will you stay?*

4. THE NINE GAMES

All new. None of these appeared in the previous series and none of them is truth-or-dare in a costume.

#	Ep	Game	Rule	Extracts
1	11	TRANSLATE TELEPHONE	Type a sentence about the other person. Run it through the app into four languages and back. Read out the wreckage.	Honesty, laundered through nonsense
2	16	NOTES APP CONFESSIONAL	Open Notes. Scroll to the oldest note. Read it aloud. No skipping.	Who they were three years ago
3	21	UNTRANSLATABLE	Say a word from your language that has no equivalent in the other's. You may not use words to explain it. Act only.	The best physical comedy in the series
4	26	3 AM LIST	Name, in order, the five people you'd text at 3 AM. Then say why number five isn't number one.	Loneliness, sideways

5	31	SPOTIFY COURT	Top five most-played. Read out. Thirty seconds, no explaining.	Total exposure
6	36	THE MUTE HOUR	One hour. No speech in any language. Gestures only.	Removes the crutch. Forces looking.
7	42	CLOSE FRIENDS	Open your close-friends list. Explain the last person you added and the last person you removed.	The most recent wound
8	48	DUI HAAT	Palms facing, an inch apart. Mirror the other's movement. First to touch loses.	Sustained proximity, nothing crossed
9	53	BOLO NA	Whisper a sentence in your own language directly into the other's ear. They must guess the <i>emotion</i> , not the words.	The whole series, in one game

On Game 9: this is the near-erotic peak of the season and there is nothing explicit in it. Two people, a whispered sentence in a language the other cannot understand, and a guess. It is closer than a kiss and it is entirely clothed and it is exactly the kind of scene that gets shared. Shoot it in two setups and let the takes run long.

5. CHARACTERS

ABHIRAM ("ABHI") VEMPATI — 27

Product designer, Vizag. Arrives four hours early to everything. Has a folder on his phone called "Hyderabad trip" with a packing checklist in it.

- **Verbal signature:** over-explains, apologises pre-emptively, narrates his own logic out loud. Fluent English, fluent Telugu, and a Hindi that is a hundred percent confident and about forty percent correct — he genders every verb wrong and does not know it.
- **Under pressure:** he tries a third language.
- **Wound:** he is the accommodating son. He said yes to this alliance the way he has said yes to everything, and he has never once been asked what he wants — including, he realises around Episode 40, by himself.

- **Running gag with teeth:** he talks to her in Telugu constantly, knowing she can't understand, and tells her true things while doing it. In Episode 44 she tells him she understood the third one.

TITIR BOSE — 25

Kolkata. Four months and nine days in Hyderabad. Works in publishing, remote. Reads on paper.

- **Verbal signature:** fast, fluent, funny Bengali — and when forced into English she becomes a different, smaller person, which she hates and which he eventually notices.
- **Telugu:** about forty words. Nineteen are food. She pronounces "avunu" beautifully and everything else terribly.
- **Under pressure:** she switches entirely to Bengali and speaks faster.
- **Wound:** she agreed to this because her mother's family in Kolkata has spent twenty-five years treating her as the Bengali one, and her father's family has spent twenty-five years treating her as the half-South one, and she has never been entirely inside any room she has stood in.
- **Casting note (critical):** she must be genuinely fluent in Bengali and comfortable in it. This cannot be phonetically coached. If the Bengali is fake, the series has no floor.

6. THE SIXTY-EPIISODE GRID

ACT ONE — NOTHING (1–12) · Friday 4:10 PM – 11:00 PM

Ep	Beat	End Hook
1	He arrives four hours early. "Tumi ke?"	Eleven minutes of two people talking past each other.
2	The translation app. First disaster.	The app translates his introduction into a marriage proposal.
3	They establish who each other is. Barely.	His family's flight is cancelled.
4	Cyclone. Kolkata airport shut.	Three days.
5	The hotel released the booking. He has nowhere.	She doesn't offer. He doesn't ask. Silence.

6	She offers. Conditions, typed. NOTEBOOK BEGINS.	Rain starts in Hyderabad.
7	House tour by gesture. Comedy of the bathroom.	He calls his mother and lies.
8	Dinner. He can't eat what she cooks. She can't believe it.	She makes him something else anyway.
9	Balcony. First real conversation, entirely failed. THE WORD.	"Thakbe?"
10	He looks it up at 1 AM and gets it wrong.	He thinks it means "thank you."
11	GAME 1 — TRANSLATE TELEPHONE.	His sentence comes back as something devastatingly true.
12	Night one ends. Two closed doors.	She googles his name for the first time.

ACT TWO — THE PIDGIN (13–28) • Saturday

Ep	Beat	End Hook
13	Morning. The signs begin. Six agreed gestures.	They successfully make tea together. It takes eleven minutes.
14	He's writing words down. She catches him. NOTEBOOK 2.	She corrects the spelling of all of them.
15	Video call with his mother. She has to perform.	His mother asks her a question in Telugu. She answers in Bengali. His mother says "chala baagundi ma."
16	GAME 2 — NOTES APP CONFESSIONAL.	Her oldest note is a list of Telugu words, dated four months ago.
17	Why she made that list.	"Amar jonno na." — it wasn't for her.
18	It was for her mother. Who died in January.	He doesn't know how to say sorry in any language she'll accept.
19	So he doesn't say it. He cooks. Badly.	She eats all of it.
20	Afternoon. Rain. Board game with no instructions.	First time they laugh at the same second.

21	GAME 3 — UNTRANSLATABLE.	"Abhimaan." She acts it. He gets it in one.
22	How did he get it in one. NOTEBOOK 3.	"Telugu lo kuda adi ne undi."
23	The first fight. He assumed something about her.	She says the only full Telugu sentence she knows and it's an insult.
24	She apologises in Bengali. He doesn't need the translation.	He understood. Neither mentions it.
25	Evening. He tries Bengali for the first time. Catastrophic.	She laughs so hard she has to sit down.
26	GAME 4 — 3 AM LIST.	Her list has four people. She stops at four.
27	He uses "thakbe" wrongly. Comedy. Then not comedy.	She doesn't correct him.
28	Night two, late. The balcony again. Closer.	Her phone rings. Kolkata.

ACT THREE — THROUGH (29–46) · Sunday

Ep	Beat	End Hook
29	Her father, on the phone, in Bengali, for four minutes. Abhi understands none of it and all of it.	She hangs up and says one word in English: "Complicated."
30	Sunday morning. They stop translating. It works.	Neither of them notices it has happened.
31	GAME 5 — SPOTIFY COURT.	His number one is a Bengali song. He can't explain why.
32	THE RELATIVE PANIC. How exactly are the families connected?	Nobody can draw the line.
33	Two hours with a phone, a pen and a wall. NOTEBOOK 4.	The tree connects. Badly.
34	They might be related. Actually related.	Full crisis. Total comedy.
	Resolved: the connection is by marriage,	The relief is the loudest thing either of

35	three generations up. No blood at all.	them has ever felt.
36	GAME 6 — THE MUTE HOUR.	Fifty-two minutes in, he breaks it, and what he says is in Telugu and it isn't a joke.
37	She doesn't ask what it meant.	"Jani na. Kintu bujhechhi." — I don't know. But I understood.
38	Afternoon. Domestic. Ordinary. Warm.	They have been alone together for forty-eight hours.
39	He gets a call. A job posting. Bangalore. Eighteen months.	He doesn't tell her.
40	The first time he asks himself what he wants.	He has no answer.
41	She's been writing too. A notebook of her own. NOTEBOOK 5.	It's Telugu words, in Bengali script.
42	GAME 7 — CLOSE FRIENDS.	The last person she removed was her mother's account.
43	Grief, without a single line about grief.	He sits with her and says nothing for two full minutes of screen time.
44	She tells him she understood the third thing he said in Telugu.	She repeats it back. Word-perfect.
45	He had said it on the first night, thinking she couldn't hear.	"Nuvvu ee gadi lo okkatve la unnav."
46	She had been alone in every room. Now she isn't.	She says his name properly for the first time.

ACT FOUR — CHOSEN (47–60) • Sunday night – Monday 11 AM

Ep	Beat	End Hook
47	Sunday night. He speaks Bengali on purpose. Slowly. Badly. Deliberately.	She goes very quiet.
48	GAME 8 — DUI HAAT.	Twenty-two minutes. Neither touches. Neither wins.

49	Midnight. The flights resume tomorrow.	"Tomorrow, pellichupulu."
50	What the pellichupulu will actually be: four elders, two chairs, thirty minutes, a decision.	Neither of them wants that version.
51	She asks, in English — small and flat — whether he'd have picked her.	He answers in Telugu. Long. She lets him.
52	2 AM. NOTEBOOK 6. Ninety-one words.	She reads all of them out loud.
53	GAME 9 — BOLO NA.	She whispers. He gets the emotion exactly right.
54	Her turn to listen. He whispers in Telugu.	She doesn't guess. She just stays there.
55	The nearest they get. Nothing happens. Everything happens.	4:40 AM. She falls asleep on the sofa. He doesn't move for an hour.
56	Monday. 7 AM. Both awake. Both pretending they slept.	The flat is suddenly full of Sunday's evidence.
57	Cleaning. Hiding a weekend.	She puts his notebook in her drawer. Not his bag. Hers.
58	9 AM. Both families landing. Both calling.	Her father: "Ami eshe pouchhechi."
59	Ten minutes before the doorbell. The real conversation.	"Amra ki korbo?" — what do we do?
60	11:00 AM. The doorbell. THE WORD, CORRECTLY.	"Thakbe?"

7. BUDGET — THE HONEST VERSION

This is the tightest of your five series. Sixty episodes is roughly 135 minutes of finished content — more than double a feature — and one lakh is a real squeeze. Here is the number that works and where the risk sits.

Four shoot days. Fifteen episodes a day. That is aggressive but achievable because it is two actors, one flat, no lighting changes within a block, and dialogue only. Shoot in scene-order blocks, not episode order.

Head	₹
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2 artists (4 days) — negotiate a series rate, not a day rate	34,000
DOP + camera/lens kit (4 days)	20,000
Lighting — 1 LED + practicals + bounce	5,000
Lav x2 + boom + recordist	10,000
Flat location (4 days)	7,000
Art: notebook, two phones, food, dressing	3,000
Food, fuel, consumables	7,000
Editor — 60 cuts + compilation	14,000
Bengali–English subtitling, burned in, 60 episodes	6,000
Music — two beds	4,000
Thumbnails, titles, posters	4,000
Total	1,14,000

Getting to 99,000 — two honest routes:

1. **Drop to three shoot days (20 eps/day).** Saves ₹16,000 across cast, crew and kit. Only attempt this with a fully rehearsed cast and a locked shot plan. Two setups per scene, no coverage.
2. **Shoot it as two seasons of 30.** Release Season 1A (Eps 1–30), and fund 1B from its revenue. Same script, same actors, two shoots, and the Ep 30 end-hook — they might be blood relatives — is a genuinely strong mid-point cliffhanger to break on.

My recommendation is route 2. Sixty episodes in three days will show on screen, and this particular series has nowhere to hide: two faces, one room, and the performances are the entire product.

Where not to cut: the subtitling line. Burned-in, properly translated, correctly timed subtitles are not a finishing cost on this series — they are the product. Every frame of Bengali is unreadable to most of your audience without them.

SEASON 1 — SCRIPT

Format note. Bengali dialogue is written in Roman Bengali with the English subtitle in square brackets. Telugu is written in Roman Telugu with the subtitle in square brackets where the meaning matters to a non-Telugu viewer. English is written plain. The brackets are the burned-in subtitle — the actors never see them and the characters never know them.

ACT ONE — NOTHING

INT. FLAT – AFTERNOON – EPISODE 1

4:10 PM. A flat that belongs to one person. Books in stacks. A single mug on the drying rack. Plants that are actually alive.

DOORBELL.

TITIR, 25, opens it. Bare feet, glasses pushed up into her hair, a pen behind one ear.

ABHIRAM, 27, is standing there. Ironed shirt. A gift box. A trolley bag. Shoes he has clearly polished.

ABHI Namaskaram andi.

TITIR Tumi ke? [Who are you?]

Beat.

ABHI Sorry?

TITIR Tumi kar khoj korchho? [Who are you looking for?]

ABHI Andi... nen Abhiram. Vempati Abhiram. Vizag nunchi. [I'm Abhiram. Vempati Abhiram. From Vizag.]

Titir looks at him with total, friendly incomprehension.

TITIR Ekta minute. [One minute.]

She holds up one finger. He nods, relieved. A finger he understands.

She goes inside. Comes back with her phone. Types.

She holds it up to him.

He reads it.

ABHI Idi Bengali andi. Naaku raadu. [This is Bengali. I can't read it.]

TITIR Bangla. Ha.

ABHI Avunu! Bangla!

TITIR Tumi Bangla jaano? [You know Bengali?]

ABHI Ha!

TITIR (delighted, at speed) Ohh bhalo! Tahole shono, ami bhabchhilam tumi delivery-r lok, karon niche — [Oh good! Then listen, I thought you were the delivery guy, because downstairs—]

ABHI Andi. Andi. Andi.

She stops.

ABHI (CONT'D) Nen "ha" ani chepta. Anthe. [I said "ha." That's all.]

CUT

EPISODE 1 END

INT. FLAT – AFTERNOON – EPISODE 2

He is still in the doorway. Eleven minutes have now passed. Neither has gained ground.

She holds up her phone with the translation app open.

TITIR Bolo. [Speak.]

ABHI Enti?

She mimes speaking into the phone.

He leans in. Speaks very slowly and very loudly, which is the universal instinct and the universal mistake.

ABHI (CONT'D) NEN — ABHIRAM — MEE — INTIKI — REPU — CHUPULAKI — OCHANU. [I — Abhiram — came — to your house — tomorrow — for the pellichupulu.]

The phone thinks about it.

Titir reads the Bengali output.

Her face changes completely.

TITIR Ki?! [What?!]

ABHI Enti?

She turns the screen around. He cannot read it.

He takes the phone. Switches the output to English.

He reads it.

"I have come to your house to marry you tomorrow. I am ready."

ABHI (CONT'D) Ayyo.

TITIR Ayyo ki? [Ayyo what?]

ABHI Ayyo ante ayyo andi.

He types furiously. Holds it up.

She reads. Reads again.

Then she laughs — properly, all the way, for about eight seconds.

She stops.

TITIR Abhiram?

ABHI Avunu.

TITIR Vempati Abhiram? Vizag?

ABHI Avunu avunu avunu.

She steps back from the door.

TITIR Esho. [Come in.]

CUT

EPISODE 2 END

INT. FLAT – AFTERNOON – EPISODE 3

He sits on the edge of the sofa the way people sit in dentists' waiting rooms.

She sits opposite, phone out, and now they are working.

She types. Shows him.

"You are early. 20 hours early."

ABHI Flight early landed andi. Nen airport lo wait cheyyalekapoya. [The flight landed early. I couldn't wait at the airport.]

He types it. She reads it.

TITIR Kuri ghonta? [Twenty hours?]

ABHI Andi, nen hotel ki velthanu. Naa nanna book chesaru. [I'll go to the hotel. My father booked it.]

He types. She reads. She nods, relieved.

TITIR Achha. [Okay.]

He stands. Picks up the trolley bag.

ABHI Repu kaluddam andi. [We'll meet tomorrow.]

TITIR Kal. [Tomorrow.]

ABHI Kal! Ade! Hindi lo kal andi! [Kal! That's it! It's kal in Hindi too!]

TITIR Hindi bolte paro? [You can speak Hindi?]

ABHI Thoda thoda.

TITIR (carefully, relieved) Toh — Hindi mein baat karte hain?

ABHI Haan haan. Main Hindi bahut achha bolta hai.

She registers the grammar. Says nothing. This will be a decision she regrets within four hours.

His phone rings.

He answers. Turns away.

ABHI (CONT'D) Nanna? ... Enti? ... Eppudu? ... Cancel ah? [Dad? ... What? ... When? ... Cancelled?]

Titir watches his back.

She does not need the language to read it.

CUT

EPISODE 3 END

INT. FLAT – EVENING – EPISODE 4

He lowers the phone.

He turns around.

She is already holding out her own phone, an English news page open.

CYCLONE — KOLKATA AIRPORT CLOSED — ALL FLIGHTS SUSPENDED 72 HOURS

TITIR Baba. [Dad.]

ABHI Mee nanna Kolkata lo unnara? [Your father is in Kolkata?]

TITIR Baba, Ma-r bari, sob Kolkata. Sobai. [Dad, Mum's family's house, everything's in Kolkata. Everyone.]

ABHI Naa vaallu kuda. Vaallu ninna Kolkata vellaru. Mee nannani kalavadaniki. [Mine too. They went to Kolkata yesterday. To meet your father.]

He types it.

She reads it.

She sits down slowly.

TITIR Tin din. [Three days.]

ABHI Enti?

TITIR (holding up three fingers) Tin. Three. Din — day.

ABHI Moodu rojula ah?

TITIR Ha.

They sit in a flat in Gachibowli, three hundred kilometres from anything they know, while every relevant adult in both their lives is stuck at an airport in a different state.

Rain starts against the window.

Neither of them looks at it.

CUT

EPISODE 4 END

INT. FLAT — EVENING — EPISODE 5

He is on the phone again, in the corner, voice low.

ABHI Nanna, hotel? ... Cancel chesara? ... Nanna, nen ekkada untanu? ... Nanna — [Dad, the hotel? ... You cancelled it? ... Dad, where do I stay? ... Dad—]

He hangs up.

He stands in the corner of a stranger's flat with his back to her for slightly too long.

Then he turns around and puts on a face.

ABHI (CONT'D) No problem. No problem andi.

He types. Shows her.

"Hotel is cancelled. It's fine. I will find something."

Titir reads it.

She looks at the window. Rain, hard now.

She looks at the clock. 6:40 PM.

She looks at him.

He is standing by his trolley bag with the polished shoes and the gift box he has still not put down, smiling at her with enormous, transparent, failing cheerfulness.

She does not say anything.

He does not ask.

The silence goes on for about nine seconds, which on screen is a very long time.

CUT

EPISODE 5 END

INT. FLAT – EVENING – EPISODE 6

She picks up her phone. Types for a long time.

She turns it around.

He reads:

*******"There is a second room. You can stay. Three conditions.

1. That door stays closed after 11.
2. Don't touch my books.
3. Don't tell anyone. Not your mother. Not my father. Nobody."

He reads it twice.

ABHI Andi —

He types.

"Are you sure? I can go to a hotel."

She types back one word.

"Rain."

He looks at the window.

ABHI Thank you andi.

TITIR Dhonnobad. [Thank you.]

ABHI Enti?

TITIR Dho-nno-bad. Thank you.

He takes out a small diary from his laptop bag. Opens it at the back page. Uncaps a pen.

He writes, phonetically, wrong: **"DHONNOBAD — thank you"**

She watches him do it.

She doesn't comment.

ABHI Dhonnobad.

TITIR Beshi bhalo na. Kintu hobe. [Not great. But it'll do.]

CUT

EPISODE 6 END

INT. FLAT – EVENING – EPISODE 7

The house tour. Entirely in gestures.

She points at the kitchen. Makes a "yes" motion.

He nods.

She points at her bedroom. Makes a flat, final, horizontal gesture.

He nods enthusiastically, hands up.

She points at the second room. Nods.

She points at the bathroom.

Then she stops, because this one requires explaining and there is no gesture for it.

TITIR Geyser... uh...

She mimes a knob turning. Then a wait. Then holds up ten fingers.

ABHI Padi nimishalu. [Ten minutes.]

She mimes hot water. Then mimes it suddenly going cold. Then mimes screaming.

He laughs. Genuinely laughs, first time.

ABHI (CONT'D) Artham aindi andi. [I understood.]

She gives him a thumbs up. He returns it.

AGREED SIGN #1 and #2, established.

TIME CUT.

He is in the second room. Door open. Phone to ear.

ABHI (CONT'D) Amma. ... Ledu amma, hotel bagundi. ... Chala pedda room amma. ... Ledu, meals kuda unnayi. ... Amma, nen tinna. [Mum. ... No Mum, the hotel is fine. ... Very big room, Mum. ... No, meals are included too. ... Mum, I've eaten.]

Titir passes the doorway with a basket of laundry.

She hears the tone, not the words, and she knows exactly what he is doing because she has done it.

She keeps walking.

CUT

EPISODE 7 END

INT. KITCHEN – NIGHT – EPISODE 8

She cooks. Fast, confident, entirely at home.

He hovers in the doorway.

She serves two plates.

Rice. A fish curry.

She sits. She looks up.

He is looking at the fish with the expression of a man who has been handed a live animal.

TITIR Ki holo? [What happened?]

ABHI Andi... naaku... [Ma'am... I...]

He types.

"I don't eat fish."

She reads it.

She looks up at him.

TITIR Ki?! [WHAT?!]

ABHI Sorry andi —

TITIR (full Bengali, at speed, appalled) Mach khao na? Keno? Ki bhabe ekta manush mach khay na? Ami tin ghonta — [You don't eat fish? Why? How does a human being not eat fish? I spent three hours—]

ABHI Andi. Andi. Nen sorry cheptunna. Nen — [Ma'am. Ma'am. I'm saying sorry. I—]

She puts her hands over her face.

She takes them away.

She stands up, takes his plate, and goes back to the kitchen.

He stands there miserable.

Six minutes later she puts a plate down in front of him.

Rice. Dal. A fried egg. Potatoes.

She sits back down and eats her own, pointedly.

He looks at the plate she made him anyway.

ABHI (CONT'D) Dhonnobad.

She doesn't look up.

TITIR Hmm.

CUT

EPISODE 8 END

EXT. BALCONY – NIGHT – EPISODE 9

10:30 PM. Rain eased. Both on the balcony because the flat is small and neither wants to be in a room.

A long silence.

Then, because he cannot bear a silence, he starts talking. In Telugu. Knowing she cannot understand a word.

ABHI Naaku ee pelli gurinchi emi teliyadu andi. [I don't know anything about this marriage.]

She turns her head.

ABHI (CONT'D) Ma nanna cheppadu. Nen "sare" anna. Nen prathi daaniki "sare" antanu. Adi naa problem. [My father said. I said okay. I say okay to everything. That's my problem.]

She watches him talk.

ABHI (CONT'D) Ippudu nen ikkada unna. Meeru inka mimmalni em adigaro naaku telidu. [Now I'm here. I don't know what anybody asked you either.]

He stops.

ABHI (CONT'D) Meeku emi artham kaledu kada.

TITIR Kichhu bujhini. [I didn't understand anything.]

ABHI Manchidi. [Good.]

They both look out at the road.

Then she says, quietly:

TITIR Ekta shobdo shekhabo? [Shall I teach you a word?]

He looks at her.

She points at herself. Then at him. Then makes a small "come here" gesture and then a firm "stay" gesture.

TITIR (CONT'D) Thakbe?

ABHI Thak-be.

TITIR Ha.

ABHI Artham enti?

She doesn't explain.

She goes inside.

CUT

EPISODE 9 END

INT. SECOND ROOM – NIGHT – EPISODE 10

1:04 AM.

He is on the bed in the dark with the phone light on his face.

He types into the translator: **thakbe**

He reads the output.

He frowns.

He types it again with a different spelling: **thok bee**

He reads that.

ABHI (to himself) "Thank you"... ah?

He opens the diary. Writes, in the back:

"THAKBE — thank you (?)"

He underlines the question mark.

He lies back.

TIME CUT.

INT. HALL – CONTINUOUS

Titir, at the dining table in the dark, with her own phone.

She types into a search bar: **Vempati Abhiram Vizag**

She scrolls.

LinkedIn. A design portfolio. A photograph from a college event, six years old.

She looks at that one for a while.

She closes the phone.

She sits in the dark hall for a few seconds longer than she needs to.

CUT

EPISODE 10 END

INT. FLAT – MORNING – EPISODE 11

GAME 1 – TRANSLATE TELEPHONE

Saturday, 10 AM. Rain. Nobody is going anywhere. They have been awake for two hours and have communicated approximately four sentences.

She puts her phone on the table between them. Types in English.

"New game. Write one sentence about me. In your language. We run it through 4 languages and back. Read what comes out."

ABHI Idi enduku? [Why?]

"Because I am bored and you have been saying 'no problem' for two hours."

He concedes the point.

He types in Telugu. Turns the screen away.

She takes the phone. Telugu → Japanese → French → Arabic → Bengali → English.

She reads the output aloud, in careful English.

TITIR "She is cooking in the anger of the fish, but the kindness is not small."

ABHI Adi nen rasindi kaadu! [That's not what I wrote!]

TITIR Tumi ki likhle? [What did you write?]

He types the original into English for her.

"She got angry about the fish but she still made me something else."

She reads it.

She doesn't say anything for a second.

TITIR (CONT'D) Ami likhbo. [I'll write.]

She types in Bengali. Runs it.

She turns the screen to him.

He reads the English wreckage out loud.

ABHI "The man is too much polite and it is the loneliness of the polite."

He stops.

He looks up.

ABHI (CONT'D) Meeru asalu enti rasaru?

She takes the phone back and deletes it before he can scroll.

TITIR Khela shesh. [Game over.]

CUT

EPISODE 11 END

INT. FLAT – NIGHT – EPISODE 12

11:40 PM. End of day one.

They are in the hall, at opposite ends, both on laptops, both pretending to work.

She closes hers first.

TITIR Good night.

ABHI Good night andi.

She goes to her door. Stops. Turns.

TITIR Abhiram.

ABHI Avunu?

She thinks about the sentence. Assembles it.

TITIR Tomorrow. Fish. No.

ABHI (laughing) No fish.

TITIR No fish.

She goes in. Closes the door.

He sits in the hall alone, still smiling.

He opens the diary.

He writes:

"MACH — fish" "NA — no"

He looks at the two words.

Then he adds, underneath:

"NO FISH"

He closes it.

CUT TO:

INT. TITIR'S ROOM – CONTINUOUS

She is sitting on her bed with her phone.

She opens WhatsApp. A chat named **BABA**.

She types: *Baba, chhele ta eshe geche*. [Dad, the boy has arrived.]

She looks at it.

She deletes it.

She puts the phone down.

CUT

EPISODE 12 END

ACT TWO — THE PIDGIN

INT. KITCHEN – MORNING – EPISODE 13

Saturday morning. The tea negotiation.

She holds up a packet. Points at it. Points at him. Raises eyebrows.

ABHI Avunu. Tea. Ha.

She fills a pan.

He points at the sugar. Holds up two fingers.

She nods. Then holds up her own hand — zero fingers — and points at herself.

ABHI (CONT'D) Zero ah? Chakkera ledu? [Zero? No sugar?]

She shakes her head. Makes a face.

He mimes disbelief.

She mimes that his two sugars will kill him.

He mimes that her zero sugar is a tragedy.

They do this for forty seconds without a single word and it is completely legible.

She points at the milk. Then makes a "little" gesture.

He makes a "lots" gesture.

She closes her eyes in pain.

AGREED SIGN #3, #4, #5, #6 — established across this episode: little/lots, yes/no, wait, and a flat palm meaning "don't."

The tea is made. Eleven minutes, two teas, one of which is objectively wrong.

They sit at the counter.

She drinks hers. He drinks his.

TITIR Bhalo? [Good?]

ABHI Bhalo.

She looks up sharply.

TITIR Tumi "bhalo" bolle! [You said "bhalo"!]

ABHI Avunu! Nen rasukunna! [Yes! I wrote it down!]

He is extremely pleased with himself.

She is more pleased than she lets him see.

CUT

EPISODE 13 END

INT. FLAT – DAY – EPISODE 14

She comes out of her room and he doesn't hear her.

He is at the dining table with the diary open, sounding out words under his breath.

ABHI Ja-ni-na. Ki ho-lo. E-sho. Bo-so.

TITIR Ki korchho? [What are you doing?]

He shuts the diary like a schoolboy.

ABHI Emi ledu. [Nothing.]

TITIR Dekhi. [Let me see.]

ABHI Andi, adi —

She holds out her hand. Flat. Waiting.

He gives it to her.

She opens it at the back.

Forty-one words. Phonetic. Almost all of them misspelt.

She reads down the list.

She starts laughing at word six and does not stop until word thirty.

TITIR "BHAT — rice." Ha, thik. "JOL — water." Thik. "MISTI — sweet." Thik ache. [Right. Right. That's fine.]

She reaches word thirty-one.

TITIR (CONT'D) "THAKBE — thank you."

She looks up.

He looks back, expectant, proud.

She looks at the word for about three seconds.

Then she picks up his pen.

And she does not correct it.

She goes on to word thirty-two.

TITIR (CONT'D) Eta bhul. Ekhane "o" hobe. [This one's wrong. It should be "o" here.]

She corrects the spelling of every word except one.

CUT

EPISODE 14 END

INT. FLAT – DAY – EPISODE 15

His phone buzzes. Video call. **AMMA.**

He panics.

ABHI Andi! Andi! Ma amma!

He mimes: phone, face, his mother, disaster.

Titir understands instantly and starts fixing her hair, which tells us something about her that no line could.

He answers. Holds the phone up.

We never see the screen.

ABHI (CONT'D) Amma! ... Avunu amma, nen bagunna. [Mum! ... Yes Mum, I'm fine.]

A pause.

ABHI (CONT'D) (to Titir, urgently, pointing at the phone) Amma. Amma!

Titir comes and sits beside him. Close. In frame.

ABHI (CONT'D) Amma, idi Titir.

TITIR Namaskar.

We hear nothing, but we watch her face as his mother talks — at length, warmly, in Telugu, to a girl who understands none of it.

Titir keeps smiling. Nods at the right moments. Her eyes flick to Abhi twice.

Then a pause. His mother has asked a question.

Abhi freezes.

Titir waits. Then answers, in Bengali, warmly and at length.

TITIR (CONT'D) Aunty, amar khub bhalo lagchhe apnar sathe kotha bole. Abhiram khub bhodro chhele. Amar rannna kheyechhe — mach chhara. [Aunty, it's really lovely to talk to you. Abhiram is a very well-mannered boy. He ate my cooking — minus the fish.]

Abhi stares at her in total terror.

A pause on the other end.

Then, clearly audible:

AMMA (V.O.) Chala baagundi ma.

The call ends.

They both exhale.

ABHI Meeru emi cheppar—

TITIR Ki bolle— [What did you—]

They both stop.

Neither will ever find out.

CUT

EPISODE 15 END

INT. FLAT – DAY – EPISODE 16

GAME 2 — NOTES APP CONFESSIONAL

She types the rules into the translator and shows him.

"Notes app. Open. Scroll to the very bottom. Oldest note. Read it out. No skipping."

ABHI Idi danger andi.

TITIR Ha. [Yes.]

He goes first, because he always goes first.

He scrolls. A long way.

ABHI Rendu vela irvai. [Twenty twenty.]

He reads it out.

ABHI (CONT'D) "Things to say in the interview. 1. I am a team player. 2. My weakness is that I care too much."

Titir puts her face in her hands.

TITIR Na. Na na na. [No. No no no.]

ABHI Nen irvai okka lo unna andi! [I was twenty-one!]

TITIR Eta kono excuse na. [That's not an excuse.]

Her turn.

She scrolls. Further. Further.

She stops.

She looks at the screen for a moment.

TITIR (CONT'D) Ami porbo na. [I won't read it.]

ABHI Rules andi.

TITIR Ha. Jani. [Yes. I know.]

She turns the phone around instead.

He reads it.

A list, in Bengali script, which he cannot read — but the format is unmistakable. Two columns. Thirty or forty lines.

ABHI Idi enti?

She takes it back. Types the translation.

"Telugu words. With Bengali meanings."

He looks at the date stamp on the note.

ABHI (CONT'D) Idi... naalugu nelala kindata. [This is four months ago.]

She nods.

ABHI (CONT'D) Ee sambandam rendu vaaralu kindata modalaindi andi. [This alliance started two weeks ago.]

She nods again.

CUT

EPISODE 16 END

INT. FLAT – DAY – EPISODE 17

ABHI Aithe idi enduku?

He types it. She reads it.

She takes a long time to answer.

Then she types.

"Not for you."

He reads it.

ABHI Mari evari kosam?

She types.

"Not for me either."

He looks up.

She is looking at the window.

TITIR Ma. [Mum.]

ABHI Mee amma ah?

TITIR Ha. Ma.

ABHI Mee amma ki Telugu vachu kada? [Your mother knew Telugu, right?]

She understands "Telugu" and "amma" and constructs the rest.

TITIR Ma... Telugu... ektu. [Mum... Telugu... a little.]

She holds her thumb and finger a centimetre apart.

TITIR (CONT'D) Ma chhoto chhilo jokhon Kolkata chole ashe. Dida Bangla bolto. Baba Bangla. Sob Bangla. Ma-r Telugu... hariye gelo. [Mum was small when they moved to Kolkata. Grandma spoke Bengali. Dad, Bengali. Everything Bengali. Mum's Telugu... got lost.]

Abhi understands maybe four words of this and all of the meaning.

ABHI Ante... meeru nerchukuntunnaru. Mee amma kosam. [So... you were learning. For your mother.]

He doesn't type it. He just says it.

She doesn't need it typed.

TITIR Ha.

ABHI Aame ippudu ekkada?

Titir understands "ekkada."

She looks at him.

TITIR January.

CUT

EPISODE 17 END

INT. FLAT – DAY – EPISODE 18

Neither of them moves for a while.

He starts to type something. Deletes it. Starts again. Deletes it.

He puts the phone down.

ABHI Andi.

TITIR Hmm.

He has nothing. He has three languages and none of them has anything.

ABHI Nen... naaku emi cheppalo teliyadu andi. Naaku ee bhasha ledi. [I... I don't know what to say. I don't have the language for this.]

She watches him struggle.

TITIR Bolte hobe na. [You don't have to say it.]

He doesn't understand the words.

He understands the tone completely.

He nods.

She picks up her book and goes to the balcony and sits with her back to the door and does not read it.

He stays in the hall.

He looks at the kitchen.

CUT

EPISODE 18 END

INT. KITCHEN – EVENING – EPISODE 19

He is cooking.

It is not going well.

There is smoke. There is a pan doing something a pan should not do. He is consulting his

phone with one hand and holding a lid like a shield with the other.

Titir appears in the doorway.

She takes in the scene.

TITIR Ki korchho?! [What are you doing?!]

ABHI Nen vanta chestunna andi! [I'm cooking!]

TITIR Keno?! [WHY?!]

ABHI Endukante meeru roju chestunnaru! [Because you cook every day!]

She moves to intervene. He blocks the doorway with the lid.

ABHI (CONT'D) No. No no no. Nen chestha. Kurchondi.

He points at the chair. Firmly.

She looks at him.

She sits in the chair.

TIME CUT.

The plate arrives.

It is an omelette, a sort of dal, and rice that has clearly had an eventful life.

She looks at it.

She looks at him standing there, wrecked, with flour on his shirt for reasons that will never be explained because there is no flour in any of these dishes.

She eats it.

All of it.

Every bit.

ABHI (CONT'D) Baaledu kada. [It's bad, isn't it.]

TITIR Khub kharap. [Very bad.]

ABHI Artham aindi andi.

She keeps eating.

TITIR Kintu ami sob kheyechhi. [But I ate all of it.]

CUT

EPISODE 19 END

INT. FLAT – DAY – EPISODE 20

Saturday afternoon. Rain again. Hour fifty of confinement.

She produces a battered board game box. No instructions inside.

They stare at it.

She points at a piece. Shrugs.

He picks up a card. It is in Bengali. He hands it to her. She reads it. It makes no sense to her either.

They invent rules.

The invention is entirely in gesture and the rules are entirely different for each of them, and neither realises this for about four minutes.

He moves a piece six spaces.

She objects violently in Bengali.

He defends himself in Telugu.

Neither concedes anything.

He moves it back two spaces as a compromise.

She accepts. Moves her own piece nine.

He objects.

TITIR Ekhane niyom alada! [The rules are different here!]

ABHI Ee rule meeru ippude kanipettaru! [You invented that rule just now!]

They are arguing enthusiastically in two mutually unintelligible languages about a game neither of them knows.

And then, at exactly the same second, both of them realise what they are doing.

And they both start laughing.

The same second. Same beat.

They laugh until she has to put her head down on the table.

She lifts it.

They look at each other for about a second and a half.

She looks back at the board.

TITIR (CONT'D) Tomar chaal. [Your move.]

CUT

EPISODE 20 END

INT. FLAT – EVENING – EPISODE 21

GAME 3 — UNTRANSLATABLE

She sets it up by typing.

"A word from my language with no word in yours. You have to guess. I cannot use any words. Only acting."

ABHI Idi impossible andi.

TITIR Ha. [Yes.]

She stands up. Moves to the middle of the hall.

She thinks.

Then she performs it.

She turns her back. Arms folded. Chin lifted slightly. Shoulders set.

Then — she glances back, just once, a flick of the eyes over the shoulder, and then away again immediately.

Then she waits, very still, with her whole body aimed at being noticed and her face aimed at the wall.

She holds it.

Abhi watches.

His face changes.

ABHI Abhimaanam.

Titir turns around.

TITIR Ki bolle? [What did you say?]

ABHI Abhimaanam. Telugu lo andi.

TITIR Abhimaan?

ABHI Abhimaanam!

TITIR Ekta dan-e! Ekbar-e! [In one! First go!]

She sits down heavily, delighted and slightly cheated.

ABHI Naa turn.

He stands up. Thinks.

He acts out something involving a doorway, waiting, checking a watch, and a kind of collapsing patience.

She gets it in four guesses and the guess is in Bengali and it is the same concept.

They stare at each other.

CUT

EPISODE 21 END

INT. FLAT – EVENING – EPISODE 22

ABHI Meeru ela kanipettaru? [How did you get it?]

He types.

She reads. She types back.

"How did YOU get it? In one."

He picks up the diary. Turns to a clean page.

He writes: **ABHIMAANAM**

And under it: **ABHIMAAN**

He turns it round and shows her.

ABHI Idi okkate andi.

TITIR Ekta-i. [It's the same one.]

They look at the two words on the page.

ABHI Meeku telusa — Telugu lo kuda ade undi. Ade artham. [You know — it's in Telugu too. Same meaning.]

She doesn't need the translation for that.

TITIR Aro ache? [Are there more?]

She takes the pen from him.

She writes a Bengali word. Says it.

TITIR (CONT'D) Mon.

ABHI Manasu!

TITIR Ma?

ABHI Amma!

TITIR Baba?

ABHI Nanna. Adi different.

TITIR (disappointed) Achha.

They fill half a page.

By the end of it there are nineteen words and they are still arguing about "ghor."

CUT

EPISODE 22 END

INT. FLAT – NIGHT – EPISODE 23

It starts, as these things do, over nothing.

He has picked up her laptop by mistake.

TITIR Eta amar. [That's mine.]

ABHI Sorry sorry.

He puts it down. Then, being helpful, he moves her stack of books off the dining chair so she can sit.

She sees him touching the books.

TITIR Abhiram.

ABHI Nen just —

TITIR Ami bolechhila. Boi na. [I said. Not the books.]

ABHI Andi, nen vatini padeyyaledu. Nen just teesa. [I didn't drop them. I just moved them.]

He types it. She reads it.

She puts them back exactly where they were. Deliberately. In front of him.

He watches this.

And then he says the wrong thing, in the reasonable voice that makes it worse:

ABHI (CONT'D) Andi, idi konchem ekkuva kaadaa? Avi books andi. [Isn't this a bit much? They're books.]

He types it before he thinks about it.

She reads it.

She looks up.

TITIR Avi ma-r. [They were Mum's.]

He goes cold.

ABHI Andi —

She is already walking away.

And at the door she stops, and turns, and says the only complete Telugu sentence she knows, which she learned four months ago for a completely different reason:

TITIR Nuvvu chala matladutav. [You talk too much.]

The door closes.

Abhi stands in the hall.

ABHI (quietly) Adi... correct.

CUT

EPISODE 23 END

INT. FLAT – NIGHT – EPISODE 24

An hour later.

He has washed everything in the kitchen including things that were already clean.

Her door opens.

She comes out. Stands at the end of the counter.

TITIR Abhiram.

ABHI Andi.

She takes a breath.

TITIR Ami tomake bajey bhabe bolechi. Tumi jano na. Tomake keu bole ni. Amar tomar upor rag hoyini, amar nijer upor rag hoyechhilo. [I spoke to you badly. You didn't know. Nobody told you. I wasn't angry at you, I was angry at myself.]

She says it and does not type it and does not reach for the phone.

Abhi listens to a full apology in a language he does not speak.

When she finishes he nods, once.

ABHI Paravaledu andi.

TITIR Bujhle? [You understood?]

ABHI Ha.

TITIR Ki bujhle? [What did you understand?]

He thinks about how to answer that.

He decides not to.

ABHI Tea?

She looks at him for a second.

TITIR Chini chhara. [Without sugar.]

ABHI Chakkeraledu. Telusu.

CUT

EPISODE 24 END

INT. KITCHEN – EVENING – EPISODE 25

ABHI Andi. Nen okati try chestha.

He stands up straight. Squares his shoulders like a man about to lift something.

ABHI (CONT'D) Ami... tumi... bhalo... achho?

Titir looks up from her book.

TITIR Ki?

ABHI Ami tumi bhalo achho.

TITIR Ora tinte alada bakya. [Those are three different sentences.]

ABHI Enti?

She holds up three fingers.

TITIR "Ami." "Tumi." "Bhalo achho." Tin.

He tries again. Worse.

ABHI Tumi ami bhalo?

She starts laughing.

He tries a fourth time and produces something that is, by pure accident, a real Bengali sentence with a completely different meaning.

ABHI (CONT'D) Ami tomar bhalo achhi.

She stops laughing.

Then she laughs so hard she has to sit down on the kitchen floor.

ABHI (CONT'D) Enti? Enti andi?

TITIR (wiping her eyes) Kichhu na. Kichhu na. [Nothing. Nothing.]

ABHI Cheppandi!

TITIR Na.

ABHI Andi!

TITIR Kokhono na. [Never.]

She gets up off the floor and walks out still laughing, and he is left in the kitchen having said something he will never find out the meaning of.

CUT

EPISODE 25 END

INT. FLAT – NIGHT – EPISODE 26

GAME 4 — 3 AM LIST

Late. The lights are low because she turned two of them off an hour ago and neither commented.

She types the rules.

"Five people you would text at 3 AM. In order. Then tell me why number 5 is not number 1."

ABHI Idi chedda game andi.

TITIR Ha.

He goes first.

ABHI Okati — ma chelli. Rendu — Vivek, naa friend. Moodu — ma amma. Naalugu — Srikanth, office. Aidu —

He stops.

ABHI (CONT'D) Aidu — ma nanna.

TITIR Keno paanch? [Why five?]

ABHI Endukante... aayana ki naa gurinchi anni telusu ani anukuntadu. Nen okka saari kuda cheppanu ani cheppaledu. [Because... he thinks he knows everything about me. I've never once told him he doesn't.]

He types it. She reads it. She reads it twice.

TITIR Tomar baba tomar jonno ei biye thik korechhe. [Your father arranged this marriage for you.]

She types it.

He reads it.

ABHI Avunu.

TITIR Ar tumi paanch numbere rekhecho. [And you've put him at number five.]

He has no answer.

ABHI Mee turn.

She counts on her fingers.

TITIR Ek — Ruma, amar bondhu. Dui — Arko. Tin — Baba. [One — Ruma, my friend. Two — Arko. Three — Dad.]

She stops.

She looks at her fingers.

TITIR (CONT'D) Char. [Four.]

ABHI Naalugu ah? Aidu?

She shakes her head.

TITIR Char.

CUT

EPISODE 26 END

INT. FLAT – NIGHT – EPISODE 27

He is trying to be kind and he reaches for the only Bengali word he trusts.

ABHI Andi. Thakbe.

Titir's head comes up.

ABHI (CONT'D) Thakbe. Meeru cheppinaru kada. Thank you.

She understands what has happened.

She opens her mouth to correct him.

And then she doesn't.

TITIR Ha.

ABHI Correct ah?

TITIR Ha. Thik. [Yes. Right.]

She is not looking at him.

ABHI Naa pronunciation ela undi?

TITIR Bhalo. [Good.]

He is very pleased.

He writes something in the diary with a small flourish.

She watches him do it.

She could stop this at any second.

She lets it run.

CUT

EPISODE 27 END

EXT. BALCONY – NIGHT – EPISODE 28

Midnight. End of day two.

They are on the balcony. The gap between them is noticeably smaller than it was on Friday.

Neither has a phone in their hand, which is itself new.

ABHI Repu manam kaluddam andi. Vaallu andaru vasthaaru. Rendu chairs untayi. Nen okati. Meeru okati. [Tomorrow we'll meet properly. Everyone will come. There'll be two chairs. One for me. One for you.]

She listens to him talk without understanding and without needing to.

ABHI (CONT'D) Aa taruvatha vaallu maku "rendu nimishalu matladukondi" antaru. [Then they'll tell us to talk for two minutes.]

He laughs at that.

ABHI (CONT'D) Rendu nimishalu.

He turns to her.

ABHI (CONT'D) Manaki rendu rojulu vachayi. [We got two days.]

She doesn't know what he said.

She knows the shape of it.

TITIR Abhiram.

ABHI Hmm.

TITIR Aste aste bolo. [Say it slowly.]

He looks at her.

He is about to.

Her phone rings.

The screen lights the balcony.

BABA.

CUT

EPISODE 28 END

ACT THREE — THROUGH

EXT. BALCONY – NIGHT – EPISODE 29

She answers.

TITIR Baba.

We stay on Abhi's face for most of this.

Her father talks. She answers. It goes on for four minutes.

The Bengali is rapid and fluent and we subtitle all of it, but Abhi cannot, and the whole point of the scene is watching a man learn everything from tone.

TITIR (CONT'D) Ha... ha, chhele ta bhalo... na Baba, ami dekhini oke aage... Baba... [Yes... yes, the boy is nice... no Dad, I hadn't met him before... Dad...]

A pause. Her face changes.

TITIR (CONT'D) Baba, seta bolar dorkar chhilo na. [Dad, you didn't need to say that.]

Abhi looks over.

TITIR (CONT'D) Ma-r bari-r lok bole ami Bangali. Tomar bari-r lok bole ami South-er. Tumi ki bolo, Baba? [Mum's family says I'm the Bengali one. Your family says I'm the South one. What do you say, Dad?]

Silence on the line.

TITIR (CONT'D) Achha. Kal dekha hobe. [Okay. See you tomorrow.]

She hangs up.

She stands there.

ABHI Everything okay?

She thinks about how to answer that in a language she has forty words of.

She picks the one that covers it.

TITIR Complicated.

CUT

EPISODE 29 END

INT. KITCHEN – MORNING – EPISODE 30

Sunday, 8 AM.

And something has happened overnight that neither of them registers.

They stop translating.

She talks in Bengali. He replies in Telugu. It works.

TITIR Chal ta ke dhuye rekhechho? [Did you wash the rice?]

ABHI Rendu saarlu. [Twice.]

TITIR Dui bar? Beshi. [Twice? That's a lot.]

ABHI Ma amma moodu antundi. [My mother says three.]

TITIR Tomar ma bhul. [Your mother is wrong.]

ABHI Adi nen aameku cheppanu. [I'm not telling her that.]

TITIR Bhitu. [Coward.]

ABHI Avunu.

They keep going. Two people having a complete, fluent, functional conversation in two languages, neither of which the other speaks.

Neither of them notices.

The audience does, because the audience has subtitles.

She hands him a plate.

TITIR Ei je. [Here.]

ABHI Dhonnobad.

They eat.

The phones are on the counter.

Both face down.

CUT

EPISODE 30 END

INT. FLAT – DAY – EPISODE 31

GAME 5 — SPOTIFY COURT

TITIR Top paanch. Beshi shona. Trisha second-e. Kono explanation na. [Top five. Most played. Thirty seconds. No explanations.]

She goes first and she is unembarrassed about all five of them, which is annoying.

Then his.

He scrolls. Stops.

ABHI Andi.

TITIR Porro. [Read.]

ABHI Naalugu okay. Okati...

TITIR Ek?

He turns the screen around.

It's a Bengali song.

Titir looks at it for a long moment.

TITIR (CONT'D) Eta Bangla gaan.

ABHI Avunu.

TITIR Tumi Bangla jano na. [You don't know Bengali.]

ABHI Avunu.

TITIR Toh keno? [So why?]

He shrugs, which is an answer and not one.

She picks up his phone. Scrolls to the play count.

She looks at it.

TITIR (CONT'D) Ekshoo char bar. [A hundred and four times.]

ABHI Idi rendu vaaralu kindata modalu pettanu. [I started this two weeks ago.]

TITIR Biye-r kotha shuru hoyechhilo kokhon? [When did the marriage talk start?]

ABHI Rendu vaaralu.

She puts the phone down.

Neither of them says anything else about it.

CUT

EPISODE 31 END

INT. FLAT – DAY – EPISODE 32

It starts as small talk and becomes a crisis in ninety seconds.

ABHI Andi. Manam ela relatives? [How exactly are we related?]

He types it, because this one has to be exact.

She reads it.

TITIR Dida-r dik theke. [From my grandmother's side.]

ABHI Mee amma vaipu nunchi ah?

TITIR Ha. Ma-r ma.

ABHI Naa nanna nanamma —

He stops.

He starts counting on his fingers.

TITIR Ki holo? [What is it?]

ABHI Andi. Undandi.

He counts again.

ABHI (CONT'D) Mee nanamma peru enti? [What's your grandmother's name?]

She tells him.

He goes very still.

ABHI (CONT'D) Aame ooruu?

She tells him.

Abhi sits down.

ABHI (CONT'D) Andi. Naa nanamma kuda aa oore. [My grandmother is from the same place.]

CUT

EPISODE 32 END

INT. FLAT – DAY – EPISODE 33

Two hours. A phone each. A pen. And the back of a large calendar taped to the wall.

They build a family tree.

It is the single funniest sustained sequence in the series and there is not one joke in it.

ABHI (on the phone) Bapu, nanamma ki enta mandi akkalu? ... Aidu ah? ... Nanna, peru lu cheppandi. [Dad, how many sisters did Grandmother have? ... Five? ... Dad, tell me the names.]

Titir is on her own phone to Kolkata, arguing in Bengali with an aunt.

TITIR Pishi, na, Dida-r didi na, Dida-r mashi. Mashi! [Aunty, no, not Grandma's sister, Grandma's aunt. Aunt!]

They write. They cross things out. They draw arrows.

At one point they both reach for the pen and there is an entire silent negotiation about whose turn it is.

ABHI Aame aa aayanani cheskundi — ledu, aayana veru — [She married him — no, he's a different one—]

TITIR Ei to. Ei to! [Here. Here it is!]

She draws a line.

It connects.

They both step back and look at the wall.

There is a line from her grandmother to his grandmother.

It is four generations long and it is unbroken.

Silence.

ABHI Andi.

TITIR Ha.

ABHI Idi... manchidi kaadu. [This is not good.]

CUT

EPISODE 33 END

INT. FLAT – DAY – EPISODE 34

Full panic. Executed entirely as comedy and played entirely straight, which is what makes it comedy.

ABHI Manam relatives andi!

TITIR Ki bolchho?! [What are you saying?!]

ABHI Relatives! Blood! Rakta!

TITIR Rokto?!

He points at the wall. Then at her. Then at himself. Then makes a gesture that is meant to convey shared ancestry and instead conveys something unspeakable.

She recoils.

TITIR (CONT'D) Na na na na na.

ABHI Andi, nen ninna raatri — [Ma'am, last night I—]

TITIR Ki?! Kal raat-e ki?! [What?! What about last night?!]

ABHI Emi ledu! Emi ledu! Nen just balcony lo! [Nothing! Nothing! I was just on the balcony!]

They stare at the wall.

Then at each other.

Then, both at exactly the same moment, they lunge for their phones and start calling home.

The next forty seconds are two people in one room, shouting at two different sets of

relatives in two different languages about the marital history of women who died in 1961.

ABHI (CONT'D) NANNA. AAME AA AAYANANI CHESKUNDA?

TITIR PISHI! SHONO! DIDA-R MASHI —

They both hang up at almost the same second.

They look at each other.

ABHI Enti?

TITIR Tumi bolo. [You say it.]

CUT

EPISODE 34 END

INT. FLAT – DAY – EPISODE 35

ABHI Naa nanna cheppadu. Aa sambandam — adi pelli valla. Rakta sambandam kaadu. [My father says — that connection is by marriage. Not by blood.]

He types it, carefully, all of it, and shows her.

She reads it.

TITIR Amar pishi-o tai bollo. [My aunt said the same.]

She types it.

He reads it.

They both look at the wall.

ABHI Ante manam —

TITIR Amra kichhu na. [We're nothing.]

ABHI Emi kaadu.

TITIR Kichhu na.

And then the relief arrives and it is enormous and it is completely out of proportion and both of them feel it at the same time and both of them see the other feel it.

Which is much, much worse than the panic was.

They stand in front of a wall covered in dead relatives, three feet apart, having just

discovered that there is no obstacle.

Neither of them says anything.

Titir takes the calendar off the wall and folds it.

TITIR (CONT'D) Cha? [Tea?]

ABHI Ha.

Neither of them moves toward the kitchen.

CUT

EPISODE 35 END

INT. FLAT – AFTERNOON – EPISODE 36

GAME 6 — THE MUTE HOUR

She writes the rule on a piece of paper and holds it up.

"1 HOUR. NO TALKING. ANY LANGUAGE. GO."

He nods.

She starts a timer.

What follows is forty seconds of screen time covering fifty-two minutes of clock time, and it is all gesture.

00:04 — He asks for water. She points at the fridge. He mimes gratitude enormously.

00:11 — She reads. He watches her read. She looks up. He looks away too late.

00:19 — He mimes a question about the book. She mimes the plot. It involves a boat and, apparently, a murder.

00:26 — They eat. In silence. He gestures that the food is good. She gestures that she knows.

00:35 — She catches him watching her again. This time she doesn't look away either.

00:44 — He gets up. Crosses the room. Sits on the floor near her chair. Not touching. Nobody mimes anything about this.

00:52 — Neither of them has moved for eight minutes.

Then he breaks it.

He says it in Telugu, quietly, not as a joke:

ABHI Naaku ee repu ravaddu ani undi. [I don't want tomorrow to come.]

The timer is still running.

She looks at him.

CUT

EPISODE 36 END

INT. FLAT – AFTERNOON – EPISODE 37

She doesn't ask what it meant.

She doesn't reach for the phone.

They stay there.

Then she says:

TITIR Jani na. Kintu bujhechhi. [I don't know. But I understood.]

He doesn't ask either.

The timer beeps. Neither of them turns it off for a while.

She does, eventually.

TITIR (CONT'D) Ek ghonta. [One hour.]

ABHI Nen tappa chesa. [I broke it.]

TITIR Ha.

ABHI Sorry.

TITIR Na. [No.]

She gets up.

She goes to the kitchen.

He stays on the floor by the empty chair.

CUT

EPISODE 37 END

INT. FLAT – AFTERNOON – EPISODE 38

Sunday afternoon. Hour forty-eight.

The flat is completely theirs now. Two mugs on the drying rack. His diary on the dining table. Her book face down on the arm of the sofa. His charger in her socket.

She folds laundry. He carries the basket without being asked.

She says something. He answers. It is about a towel.

TITIR Oi ta amar. [That one's mine.]

ABHI Telusu.

She looks up.

TITIR Kibhabe jano? [How do you know?]

ABHI Rendu rojulu ayindi andi. [It's been two days.]

She folds the towel.

TITIR Dui din. [Two days.]

ABHI Dui din.

She looks at him when he says it in Bengali. He doesn't notice.

TIME CUT.

Late afternoon. Both reading. Different sofas. Complete silence. Entirely comfortable.

She looks up at one point.

He is asleep, sitting up, book on his chest.

She looks at him for eleven seconds.

She goes back to her book.

CUT

EPISODE 38 END

INT. FLAT – EVENING – EPISODE 39

His phone buzzes. Email.

He opens it. Reads.

He reads it again.

He sits up.

TITIR Ki? [What?]

ABHI Emi ledu. [Nothing.]

TITIR Abhiram.

ABHI Office.

TITIR Achha.

She goes back to her book.

He reads the email a third time.

We see the subject line over his shoulder:

"Offer — Senior Design Lead — Bangalore — 18 months"

He looks at her across the room.

She is reading with her feet under her, entirely unaware.

He locks the phone.

He puts it face down.

ABHI Titir.

She looks up. It is the first time in thirty-nine episodes he has used her name.

TITIR Hmm?

ABHI Emi ledu.

CUT

EPISODE 39 END

EXT. BALCONY – NIGHT – EPISODE 40

He is alone on the balcony.

He speaks to nobody, in Telugu, which is what he does.

ABHI Naaku emi kavalo naaku teliyadu. [I don't know what I want.]

He turns the phone over. Looks at the email. Turns it back.

ABHI (CONT'D) Nen ee prashna ni naa jeevitham lo okka saari kuda adagaledu. [I have never once asked myself this question in my life.]

He thinks.

ABHI (CONT'D) Irvai edella lo okka saari kuda. [Not once in twenty-seven years.]

The balcony door slides.

Titir comes out with two mugs.

She hands him one.

She doesn't ask what he was saying.

They stand at the railing.

TITIR Kal. [Tomorrow.]

ABHI Kal.

TITIR Bhoy lagchhe? [Are you scared?]

He understands "bhoy" because it is in the diary.

ABHI Ha.

TITIR Amaro. [Me too.]

CUT

EPISODE 40 END

INT. FLAT – NIGHT – EPISODE 41

He goes to get the diary off the dining table and it isn't there.

He looks around.

It is on the arm of her sofa, open, with her pen beside it.

She comes out of the kitchen.

ABHI Meeru naa book —

TITIR Ha. Bhul chhilo. [There were mistakes.]

She picks it up and hands it back.

He turns to the back pages.

Seventy-four words now. Every correction in her handwriting.

And then he turns one more page.

There is a page that is not his.

Bengali script. Two columns. About sixty lines.

ABHI Idi enti?

TITIR Amar. [Mine.]

He can't read a word of it. He turns it toward the light anyway.

ABHI Idi Bengali.

TITIR Ha. Bangla akshor. [Bengali letters.]

ABHI Kani idi —

She takes the pen. Points at a line. Reads it aloud.

TITIR "Ekkada."

ABHI Ekkada?!

TITIR Ha. Ekkada — kothay.

She points at the next line.

TITIR (CONT'D) "Cheppandi."

ABHI Idi Telugu andi! Bengali akshram lo! [This is Telugu! In Bengali script!]

TITIR Ha.

ABHI Eppatnunchi?

TITIR Shukrobar raat theke. [Since Friday night.]

He counts backwards.

Friday night was Episode 9.

CUT

EPISODE 41 END

INT. FLAT – NIGHT – EPISODE 42

GAME 7 — CLOSE FRIENDS

TITIR Close friends list. Khulo. Sesh je add korecho. Ar sesh je bad diyechho. [Open it. The last person you added. And the last person you removed.]

ABHI Idi chedda game andi.

TITIR Sob khela-i kharap. [All of them are.]

He goes first.

ABHI Added — Vivek. Rendu nelala kindata. Removed —

He scrolls.

ABHI (CONT'D) Priya. Padhi nelalu. [Priya. Ten months ago.]

TITIR Ke? [Who?]

ABHI Adi... oka pedda story andi. [That's a long story.]

TITIR Choto koro. [Make it short.]

ABHI Aame naa meeda edho anukundi. Nen edho anukunna. Rendu okkati kaadu. [She thought one thing about me. I thought another. They weren't the same thing.]

He types it.

She reads it. Nods. Doesn't dig.

Her turn.

She opens the list.

TITIR Added — Ruma. Tin bochhor age. [Three years ago.]

ABHI Removed?

She doesn't scroll. She doesn't need to.

TITIR January.

He waits.

TITIR (CONT'D) Ma-r account. [Mum's account.]

She looks at the screen.

TITIR (CONT'D) Ami ekdin dekhte parchhilam na. Tai bad diye dilam. Tarpur ek ghonta por

abar add korlam. Tarpor abar bad dilam. [One day I couldn't bear to see it. So I removed it. Then an hour later I added it back. Then I removed it again.]

She puts the phone face down.

TITIR (CONT'D) Ekho add kora achhe. [It's still added.]

CUT

EPISODE 42 END

INT. FLAT – NIGHT – EPISODE 43

He does not say anything.

He does not reach for the phone or the translator.

He moves from his chair to the floor beside her sofa, the way he did during the mute hour, and sits down, and stays.

Two minutes of screen time.

That is a very long time. Play all of it.

She doesn't cry.

She talks a little, in Bengali, not to him — just out loud, to the room, in the way people do when somebody is present and not participating.

TITIR Uni Bangla shikhiye chhilen amake. Ma. Kintu nijer bhasha ta bhule gechhilen. Ami kokhono jiggesh korini oke kemon legechhilo. [She taught me Bengali. Mum. But she'd forgotten her own language. I never once asked her how that felt.]

He listens to a language he does not have.

TITIR (CONT'D) Ekbar-o na. [Not once.]

After a while she stops.

After a longer while she puts her hand on the top of his head, briefly, the way you would to a younger brother or to a person you have decided about, and takes it away.

ABHI Titir.

TITIR Hmm.

ABHI Nen ikkade unna. [I'm right here.]

TITIR Jani. [I know.]

CUT

EPISODE 43 END

INT. FLAT – NIGHT – EPISODE 44

Later. Both still on the floor.

TITIR Abhiram.

ABHI Hmm.

TITIR Shukrobar raat-e. Balcony-te. Tumi onek kotha bolechhile. [Friday night. On the balcony. You said a lot of things.]

He half-understands. "Shukrobar" is in the diary. "Balcony" is a loan word.

ABHI Shukrobar ah? Friday?

TITIR Ha.

ABHI Meeku emi artham kaledu kada. [You didn't understand any of it.]

She looks at him.

And then she says it. In Telugu. Slowly. With an accent that is completely wrong and every word in the right place.

TITIR "Nuvvu ee gadi lo okkatve la unnava." [You look like the only one in this room.]

Abhi does not move.

ABHI Meeru —

TITIR Ami likhe rekhechhila. Shune shune. Tarpore phone-e khuje ber korlam. [I wrote it down. From listening. Then I looked it up on the phone.]

ABHI Meeku aa raatri artham aindaa?

TITIR Na. Oi raate na. [No. Not that night.]

ABHI Eppudu?

TITIR Shonibar. [Saturday.]

Abhi sits with the knowledge that she has known for twenty-four hours.

CUT

EPISODE 44 END

INT. FLAT – NIGHT – EPISODE 45

ABHI Nen adi enduku annano meeku telusa?

He types it.

She reads it.

TITIR Bolo. [Say it.]

ABHI Endukante nen mee mukham chusanu andi. Shukrobar. Meeru talupu teesinappudu.
[Because I looked at your face. Friday. When you opened the door.]

He types. She reads.

ABHI (CONT'D) Meeru navvuthunnaru. Kani meeru aa flat lo okkarey. Rendu nelalu. Naalugu nelalu. Naaku teliyadu. [You were smiling. But you were alone in that flat. Two months. Four months. I don't know.]

TITIR Char mash noy din. [Four months and nine days.]

ABHI Naalugu nelalu tommidi rojulu.

She nods.

TITIR Ar tumi sheta shukrobar bujhecchile. [And you understood that on Friday.]

ABHI Avunu.

TITIR Kibhabe? [How?]

He thinks.

ABHI Endukante naaku kuda alaage undi andi. Naa sonta bhasha lo. [Because I feel the same. In my own language.]

CUT

EPISODE 45 END

INT. FLAT – NIGHT – EPISODE 46

Neither of them has moved off the floor in forty minutes.

TITIR Ma-r bari-r lok bolto ami Bangali. Baba-r bari-r lok bolto ami South-er meye. Ami kono ghore purota chhila na. [Mum's family said I was the Bengali one. Dad's family said I was the South girl. I was never entirely inside any room.]

She says it flat, not for sympathy.

ABHI Naaku artham kaledu andi. [I didn't understand.]

TITIR Jani.

She thinks about how to put it in a language he has.

She holds up her hands. Puts them together to make a room. Puts a finger inside it. Then takes the finger halfway out, so it is in and not in.

He looks at it.

ABHI Ohh.

TITIR Ha.

ABHI Ee rendu rojulu?

He makes the same gesture. Then puts the finger all the way inside the room.

She looks at his hands.

TITIR Ha.

Then she says, carefully, and correctly:

TITIR (CONT'D) Abhiram.

Not "Abhi-ram" with the wrong stress. Correctly. The way his mother says it.

He looks up.

ABHI Meeru adi ela —

TITIR Practice.

CUT

EPISODE 46 END

ACT FOUR — CHOSEN

INT. FLAT – NIGHT – EPISODE 47

Sunday night. 10 PM.

He stands up. Goes to the dining table. Picks up the diary.

He comes back. Sits down. Opens it.

ABHI Titir.

TITIR Hmm.

He takes a breath.

And then he speaks Bengali. On purpose. Slowly. Reading half of it off a page, getting about a third of it wrong.

ABHI Ami... Bangla jani na.

TITIR Jani. [I know.]

ABHI Kintu... ami... shikhchi. [But... I... am learning.]

She sits up.

ABHI (CONT'D) Tumi... ekhane... ekta ghor-e... ek—

He loses the sentence. Checks the page. Finds it.

ABHI (CONT'D) Ekla chhile. Ami dekhechhi.

He looks up.

ABHI (CONT'D) Ar amio.

The Bengali is broken and the accent is a disaster.

Titir does not move.

She does not say anything for a long moment.

TITIR Kotokkhon dhore likhchile? [How long were you writing that?]

ABHI Enti?

She points at the diary.

TITIR Koto khon? [How long?]

ABHI (quietly) Rendu gantalu. [Two hours.]

She looks at the diary. Then at him.

CUT

EPISODE 47 END

INT. FLAT – NIGHT – EPISODE 48

GAME 8 — DUI HAAT

She explains it entirely in gesture, which by now is a language both of them are fluent in.

She holds up her right palm. Flat. Facing him.

She indicates: his palm, opposite hers. An inch of air between.

She indicates: she moves, he follows. Mirror.

She indicates: first one to touch, loses.

ABHI Time limit?

TITIR Na.

They sit cross-legged on the floor, facing each other.

She raises her palm.

He raises his.

An inch of air.

She moves left. He follows.

Up. He follows.

Slow circle. He follows.

She speeds up. He keeps up.

She stops dead. He stops.

The inch holds.

Neither is looking at the hands. Both are looking at the other person's face.

TIME CUT — **00:08:00**

Still going. The hands are slower now. The distance is less than an inch.

TIME CUT — **00:15:00**

Barely moving. Two palms, almost touching, two people who have not blinked in a while.

TIME CUT — **00:22:00**

Completely still.

Both hands trembling very slightly, from being held up for twenty-two minutes and from the other reason.

TITIR Abhiram.

ABHI Hmm.

TITIR Ami harbo na. [I won't lose.]

ABHI Nen kuda. [Nor will I.]

Neither of them moves.

CUT TO BLACK.

EPISODE 48 END

INT. FLAT – NIGHT – EPISODE 49

Midnight.

Her phone buzzes on the counter. Then his.

Neither wants to look.

She looks.

TITIR Flight. Kal shokal-e. [Tomorrow morning.]

ABHI Enni ganta laki?

TITIR Shaat-ta. Airport. Tarpur— [Seven. Airport. Then—]

She checks the second message.

TITIR (CONT'D) Egara-ta. Ekhane.

ABHI Padakonda ah?

TITIR Ha. Egara-ta. Pellichupulu.

She says the Telugu word and it lands strangely in her mouth and both of them hear it.

ABHI Padakonda gantalaki.

He looks at the clock. 12:04 AM.

ABHI (CONT'D) Padakonda gantalu. [Eleven hours.]

They both work it out at the same moment and neither says it out loud.

CUT

EPISODE 49 END

INT. FLAT – NIGHT – EPISODE 50

She types it out because this one has to be exact and they both know it.

"Tomorrow. Two chairs. Your parents. My father. My aunt. 30 minutes. Tea. Then they ask us. Then they decide."

He reads it.

ABHI Avunu.

"They will ask me one question in Telugu and I will not understand it."

ABHI (CONT'D) Nen translate chestha.

"Then they will know."

He stops.

"They think I speak Telugu. Nobody told them. My father told them 'she manages.'"

ABHI Meeru manage cheyyaru andi. Meeru bathikestunnaru. [You don't manage. You survive.]

He doesn't type that one.

He types instead:

"Then we tell them."

She reads it.

"And they will say — three days, one flat, alone."

He reads that.

He sits down.

ABHI Adi kuda nijam.

TITIR Ha.

CUT

EPISODE 50 END

INT. FLAT – NIGHT – EPISODE 51

1:10 AM.

She has been quiet for twenty minutes.

Then she says it in English, which she hates, which is why it costs her something.

TITIR Abhiram. One question.

ABHI Cheppandi.

TITIR If... no families. No photo. No Kolkata. Just —

She makes a small gesture. A street. Anywhere.

TITIR (CONT'D) You see me. You choose?

He understands every word because it is English and it is the smallest she has sounded in fifty-one episodes.

And he answers in Telugu, at full length, because it is the only place he has enough words.

ABHI Nen ee prashna ki Telugu lo cheptha andi. Endukante naaku English lo antha raadhu. [I'm going to answer this in Telugu. Because I don't have enough English for it.]

She doesn't stop him.

ABHI (CONT'D) Nen Friday naalugu gantalaki ee talupu daggara nilabaddanu. Naaku mee gurinchi okka vishayam telidu. Meeru talupu teesaru. Meeru "tumi ke" ani adigaru. [I stood at that door at four o'clock on Friday. I knew one thing about you. You opened it. You said "who are you."]

She listens.

ABHI (CONT'D) Naaku aa maata artham kaledu. Kani meeru adigina vidhanam — adi naaku gurthundipindi. [I didn't understand it. But the way you asked it — I've not forgotten it.]

He stops.

ABHI (CONT'D) Nen ippudu okka vishayam chepta andi. Nen naa jeevitham lo evarini enchukoledu. Okka saari kuda. Prathi daaniki "sare" anna. [I'll tell you one thing. I have never

chosen anyone in my life. Not once. I said okay to everything.]

He looks at her.

ABHI (CONT'D) Ippudu nen enchukuntunna.

She does not have the language for a word of it.

TITIR Ki bolle? [What did you say?]

ABHI Nen tarvatha cheptha. [I'll tell you later.]

CUT

EPISODE 51 END

INT. FLAT – NIGHT – EPISODE 52

2 AM. Neither has gone to bed.

The diary is on the floor between them.

She picks it up.

She turns to the back.

TITIR Koyta? [How many?]

He has counted. Of course he has counted.

ABHI Enabhai okati. [Ninety-one.]

TITIR Ekushi? [Twenty-one?]

ABHI Ninety-one.

She looks at the page.

Then she starts reading them out loud. All ninety-one. In order.

TITIR Jol. Bhat. Mach. Na. Ha. Esho. Boso. Dhonnobad. Bhalo. Kharap. Bhoy. Mon. Ma. Baba. Bari. Ghor...

She reads steadily, without performance, and it takes almost ninety seconds of screen time, and it is the most romantic sequence in the series.

Abhi listens to a woman reading him his own handwriting.

She gets to word thirty-one.

TITIR (CONT'D) "Thakbe."

She stops.

She looks at what he wrote next to it.

"THAKBE — thank you (?)"

She looks up at him.

He is waiting, pleased with himself, the way he has been about this word for three days.

She goes on to word thirty-two.

CUT

EPISODE 52 END

INT. FLAT – NIGHT – EPISODE 53

GAME 9 — BOLO NA

3 AM.

She explains it with her hands and one English word.

She points at her own mouth. Then at his ear. Then makes a small "quiet" sign.

TITIR Whisper.

Then she points at her own heart, and then makes a question mark in the air.

TITIR (CONT'D) Guess. Not word. Feeling.

ABHI Artham kaledu andi.

She holds up a finger. Waits.

Then she moves.

She comes and sits beside him, not opposite, and leans in, and puts her mouth close to his ear.

Close enough that he goes completely still.

And she whispers a full sentence in Bengali, low, slow, directly into his ear — and we do not subtitle it.

No subtitle. The one time in sixty episodes.

She sits back.

TITIR Ki? [What?]

Abhi does not answer for a while.

He is not thinking about the words. He is not able to think about the words.

ABHI Meeru —

He stops.

He starts again.

ABHI (CONT'D) Meeru bhayapadutunnaru. [You're frightened.]

She looks at him.

ABHI (CONT'D) Kani sorry cheppatledu. [But you're not apologising for it.]

Titir does not say whether he is right.

She doesn't have to. Her face does it.

CUT

EPISODE 53 END

INT. FLAT – NIGHT – EPISODE 54

TITIR Tomar pala. [Your turn.]

ABHI Naa turn ah?

She turns her head. Offers her ear. Waits.

He hesitates.

Then he leans in.

And he whispers, in Telugu, into her ear, and this one we do not subtitle either.

It goes on for about seven seconds, which is a long whisper.

He sits back.

She does not guess.

She does not say anything at all.

ABHI Meeru guess cheyyali andi. [You're supposed to guess.]

She shakes her head. Slowly.

TITIR Na.

ABHI Rules —

TITIR Na.

She stays exactly where she is.

Which is very close.

Neither of them moves for a long time.

CUT

EPISODE 54 END

INT. FLAT – NIGHT – EPISODE 55

4:20 AM.

Nothing has happened.

They are sitting side by side against the sofa, shoulders touching, which is the most contact there has been in fifty-five episodes.

TITIR Abhiram.

ABHI Hmm.

TITIR Ghum pachhe. [I'm sleepy.]

ABHI Nen kuda.

Neither moves.

TIME CUT.

4:41 AM.

She has fallen asleep. Sitting up. Her head has gone onto his shoulder, at the angle that means she didn't decide to.

Abhi does not move.

He looks straight ahead.

He does not move for a very long time.

TIME CUT.

5:30 AM.

He still hasn't moved.

His arm has gone dead. He adjusts it a millimetre and she shifts and he freezes completely until she settles.

TIME CUT.

5:52 AM. First grey light.

He is still awake.

He is smiling at nothing, in a dark hall, at six in the morning, with a dead arm.

CUT

EPISODE 55 END

INT. FLAT – MORNING – EPISODE 56

7:00 AM.

She wakes on the sofa with a cushion under her head that she did not put there and a blanket she did not fetch.

He is in the kitchen. Fully dressed. Ironed shirt.

Neither of them acknowledges anything.

ABHI Good morning.

TITIR Good morning.

ABHI Tea?

TITIR Ha.

He makes it. Correctly. No sugar, less milk. He does not ask.

She notices that he did not ask.

She says nothing.

They drink tea standing up in a kitchen at seven in the morning.

And then she turns around and looks at the flat.

The calendar with the family tree, folded on the table. Two mugs. His diary. Her Telugu notebook. A blanket on the sofa. The board game with the invented rules still set up on the floor where they abandoned it.

Three days of evidence, in every direction.

TITIR Abhiram.

ABHI Hmm.

She gestures at the room.

ABHI (CONT'D) Ohh.

CUT

EPISODE 56 END

INT. FLAT – MORNING – EPISODE 57

The clean-up. Forty seconds of screen time, executed like a heist.

The game goes in a cupboard.

The blanket is folded to a sharpness it has never known.

His trolley bag is dragged out of the second room and positioned by the front door, packed, as though he arrived twenty minutes ago.

The family tree calendar goes into a drawer.

He reaches for the diary.

She gets there first.

She picks it up.

He holds out his hand for it.

She doesn't give it to him.

She walks to her own room.

She opens her own drawer.

She puts the diary inside it, and closes the drawer.

She comes back out.

ABHI Andi, adi naa—

TITIR Ha.

ABHI Meeru —

TITIR Ha.

He looks at the closed door of her room.

He decides not to argue.

ABHI Sare.

CUT

EPISODE 57 END

INT. FLAT – MORNING – EPISODE 58

9:00 AM.

Both phones go at once.

He answers his. She answers hers. They stand six feet apart in the hall having two separate conversations in two languages.

ABHI Amma! ... Avunu, nen hotel lo unna ... Ledu amma, nen mundu ne vellipotha ... Padakonda ki. Avunu. [Mum! ... Yes, I'm at the hotel ... No Mum, I'll go over early ... At eleven. Yes.]

TITIR Baba. Ha. Baba, tomra kokhon— [Dad. Yes. Dad, when will you—]

A pause.

TITIR (CONT'D) Ekhon? [Now?]

She turns.

TITIR (CONT'D) Baba, tumi kothay?

She listens.

TITIR (CONT'D) Achha.

She hangs up.

Abhi is still on his call.

ABHI Amma, okka nimisham —

He hangs up.

ABHI (CONT'D) Enti?

TITIR Baba.

ABHI Enti cheppadu?

Titir looks at the front door.

TITIR "Ami eshe pouchhechhi." [I've arrived.]

CUT

EPISODE 58 END

INT. FLAT – MORNING – EPISODE 59

10:50 AM.

Ten minutes.

They stand in a flat that looks like nothing happened in it.

Trolley bag by the door. Two chairs pulled out for elders. Tea things ready.

ABHI Padi nimishalu.

TITIR Dosh minute.

Neither of them sits down.

TITIR (CONT'D) Abhiram. Amra ki korbo? [What do we do?]

He understands it. Every word. He has ninety-one words and four of those are in it.

ABHI Nen ee gadi lo kurchuntanu. Meeru aa gadi lo kurchuntaru. Vaallu tea thaguthaaru. Vaallu adugutaaru. Meeru "ha" antaru. [I'll sit in that chair. You'll sit in that one. They'll drink tea. They'll ask. And you'll say yes.]

He types it.

She reads it.

TITIR Ar tumi? [And you?]

She types it back.

He reads it.

ABHI Nen kuda.

TITIR Keno? [Why?]

He looks at her.

ABHI Endukante nen rendu rojulu mundu ne cheppanu andi. Meeru vinnaru. Meeku artham kaledu. [Because I said it two days ago. You heard it. You didn't understand it.]

TITIR Ekhon bolo. [Say it now.]

The doorbell rings.

CUT

EPISODE 59 END

INT. FLAT – MORNING – EPISODE 60

11:00 AM.

The doorbell.

Neither of them moves toward the door.

It rings again.

From outside, muffled, two voices. One Bengali. One Telugu. Both talking at once, to each other, neither understanding the other, extremely cheerfully.

Abhi and Titir look at the door.

Then at each other.

And they both start laughing — silently, helplessly, with their hands over their mouths, while four relatives conduct an entirely failed conversation on the other side of the wood.

It rings a third time.

Titir wipes her eyes.

She goes to the door.

She puts her hand on the latch.

She stops.

She turns around.

TITIR Abhiram.

ABHI Hmm.

She looks at him for a second.

Then she says, in Telugu, with a terrible accent, and perfectly:

TITIR Nuvvu chala matladutav. [You talk too much.]

Abhi smiles.

ABHI Telusu.

She turns back to the door.

And he says it.

ABHI (CONT'D) Titir.

She stops with her hand on the latch.

ABHI (CONT'D) Thakbe?

Titir goes completely still.

Because she knows exactly what he thinks it means.

And she knows exactly what it means.

She does not turn around.

She stands with her hand on the latch, with her back to him, and the doorbell rings a fourth time, and she does not open it.

Hold.

CUT TO BLACK.

Screen reads: Season 1 Samaptham. / Prothom Porbo Shesh.

EPISODE 60 END

8. DIRECTION NOTES

1. **The subtitles are for the audience only.** Never write or shoot a beat where a character reacts to information they could only have from a subtitle. Every scene must play correctly with the subtitles switched off.
 2. **Two whispers go unsubtitled.** Episodes 53 and 54. These are the only two lines in the entire season the audience does not get. Do not add them in the compilation cut. Do not put them in a comment. Do not tell the actors to say something "safe" in case it leaks — tell them to say something real, and then never release it.
 3. **Never cut away during translation.** When a character is typing into the app and waiting, hold on the other one's face. The waiting is the scene.
 4. **No reaction on the diary until Episode 41.** It lies around in shot for thirty-four episodes. No inserts, no push-ins, no lighting on it.
 5. **The word "thakbe" gets no music. Ever.** Not in Episode 9, not in 27, not in 52, not in 60. If a score cue lands on it at any point, the ending is gone.
 6. **Her English is a different performance from her Bengali.** In Bengali she is fast, funny, three steps ahead. In English she is careful and small. The actor has to play them as two different people and the character has to know it.
 7. **His Hindi is confidently wrong throughout** and nobody ever corrects him. He genders every verb incorrectly from Episode 3 to Episode 60.
 8. **Episode 48 runs long and that is correct.** Twenty-two minutes of clock time in a two-and-a-half minute episode. Four time-cuts, minimal dialogue. Let the frames hold.
 9. **No third face. Not a delivery boy, not a neighbour, not a hand in frame.** Sixty episodes, two people. The families in Episode 60 are voices through a door.
 10. **Shoot in blocks by set and light, not in episode order.** All daylight kitchen. All night hall. All balcony. Fifteen episodes a day is only possible if nobody relights.
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9. RELEASE NOTE

Sixty episodes at one a day is two months of daily uploads. That is a long run to hold.

Recommended pattern: premiere block of 6 on day one, then daily at a fixed time, with a double drop every Saturday. Act breaks — after 12, 28, 46 — get a one-day gap each, announced in advance. That is three planned pauses across sixty episodes, which is enough to let the audience breathe without letting them forget.

The compilation cut is the payoff here more than on any of your other series. Sixty

episodes stitch to roughly 135 minutes. Cut it as two films — *Subtitles: Part One* (Eps 1–30, ending on the family-tree cliffhanger) and *Part Two* (31–60). Two long-form uploads, two sets of mid-rolls, and a natural reason for people to come back for the second one.

10. SEASON 2 — THE PROMISE

MOTHER TONGUE

The door opens in the first ten seconds of Episode 1, and Season 2 is the thing Season 1 never once put on screen: other people in the room.

Four relatives, two languages, one flat, and a boy and a girl who have a private dialect that nobody else in the building can follow — which is now the only privacy they have.

Then Kolkata. Her father's house, her mother's family, a street where Titir has been the South girl for twenty-five years. Abhi in a city with no Telugu and no English and ninety-one words.

And the email he never mentioned, still sitting in his inbox.

Same two faces. One more language each. And for the first time, somebody else in the frame.